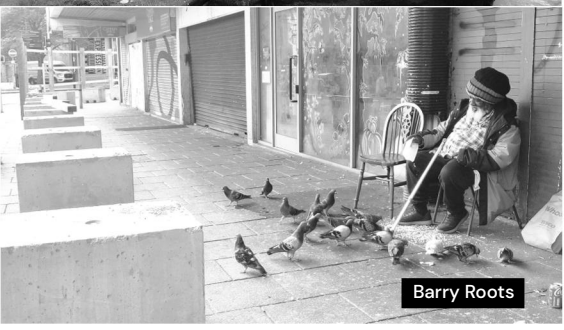



Bingley North Bog

Bogs of Bratfud




Barry Roots

Nurture

I live in the city centre surrounded by large, grey buildings. Nature is something you read about in story books or on social media posts. As I am also disabled with limited mobility, this makes visiting nature less of a priority and more of a wish list. With this residency, I feel like I have a purpose to leave the city.

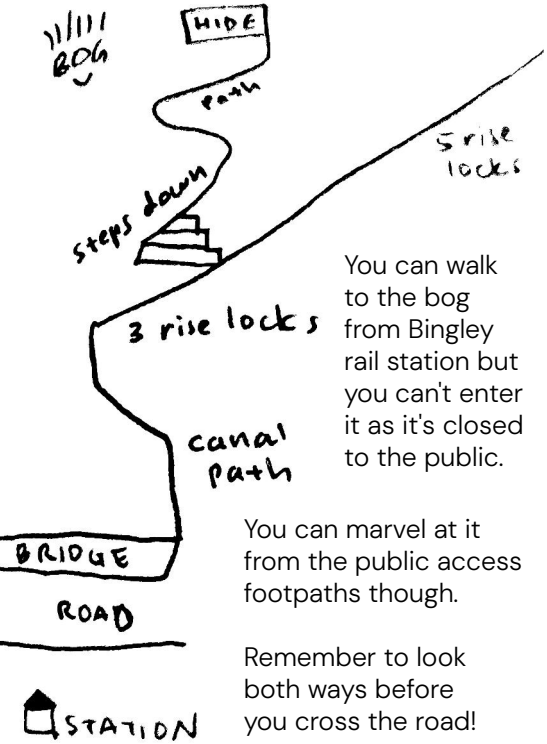
Wot's a Bog?

The only bog I knew came from a video game; The Witcher. So imagine my surprise (and delight) to find out that we had bogs in Bradford. Obviously, they are not the same; there are no witches for instance and you are not suddenly trapped in a blanket of mist, fighting for your life because you are now in the presence of a bog monster or three.

Bogs of Bratfud

The bogs in Bradford are wonderful ecosystems that host and feed a diverse bunch of species; wildlife, plants and us - the humans. Most importantly, the peatlands found in bogs are incredible at taking carbon from the air and storing it. Bogs play a significant role against climate change and if they were to degrade, all this stored carbon could be released, accelerating global warming!


Bridestones Bog



You can walk to the bog from Bingley rail station but you can't enter it as it's closed to the public.

You can marvel at it from the public access footpaths though.

Remember to look both ways before you cross the road!

Hide and seek

If you do manage to get to the footpath, you'll be greeted by a lush green meadow full of wildflowers. At the end of this path is a bird hide where you can pause and look at the bog from the cut out hidey holes. I'm not really sure what a bird hide is but I am going to assume that it is a place where you can watch birds and stay hidden so you don't scare them off.



Squawks

I haven't seen a bird through the bird hide yet but I have seen a peregrine falcon, plenty of house martins and a couple of herons facing away from the hide. There were plenty of other birds making a racket in the trees but I couldn't make out what they were. They did fly away when I tried to move closer so maybe I should have stayed hidden after all!

Residency

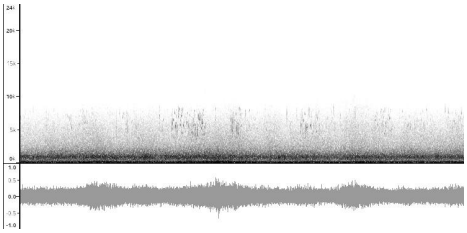
I wanted to give a voice to the less visible creatures of the bog; *bats, amphibians, insects, and all other myriads of creepy crawlies so have taken many field recordings of Bingley North Bog over many days, from sunrise to sunset. One thing remains a permanent fixture throughout the audio - the **traffic noise** of the A650 motorway. It is ever present, be it at 5am or 9pm.





Bird song

This image is a visual representation of a recording that I took at sunrise.



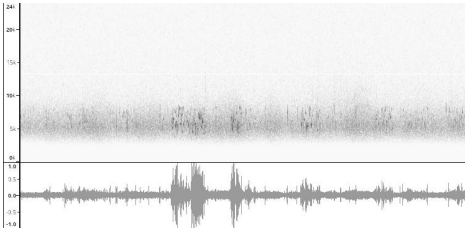
The top half is a spectrogram and the bottom bit is a waveform.

A spectrogram shows all the different frequencies that one hears over time. It's like an audio graph! A waveform can show you how loud a sound is by its shape and size.

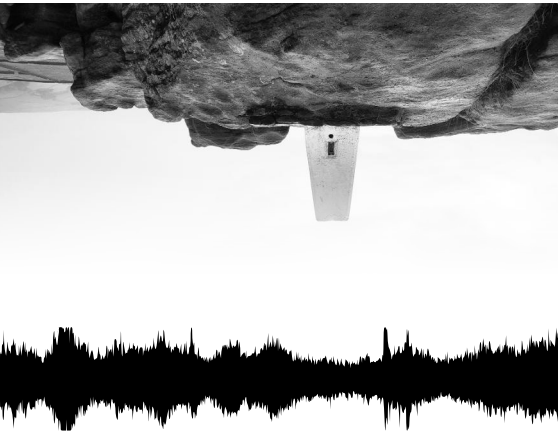
5000Hz

When I removed all the noise below a certain level (5000Hz), suddenly the traffic noise disappears and the bog creatures are revealed. It was like I had cleared the fog and there was life everywhere, all this time!

Look at this image and compare it to the previous one. What changed?



Wildlife hiding in the the higher frequencies.



field recording of the traffic at t' bog

Duet

On Sunday, 25th October 2026, I will be performing with my friend, Alice Gilmour as part of our duo, Gilank. It will be an hour long set where we use field recordings and experiences from our bog visits to tell a story about the impact of human activities on our nature reserves and what it could mean for the creatures that live within it.



Bridestones



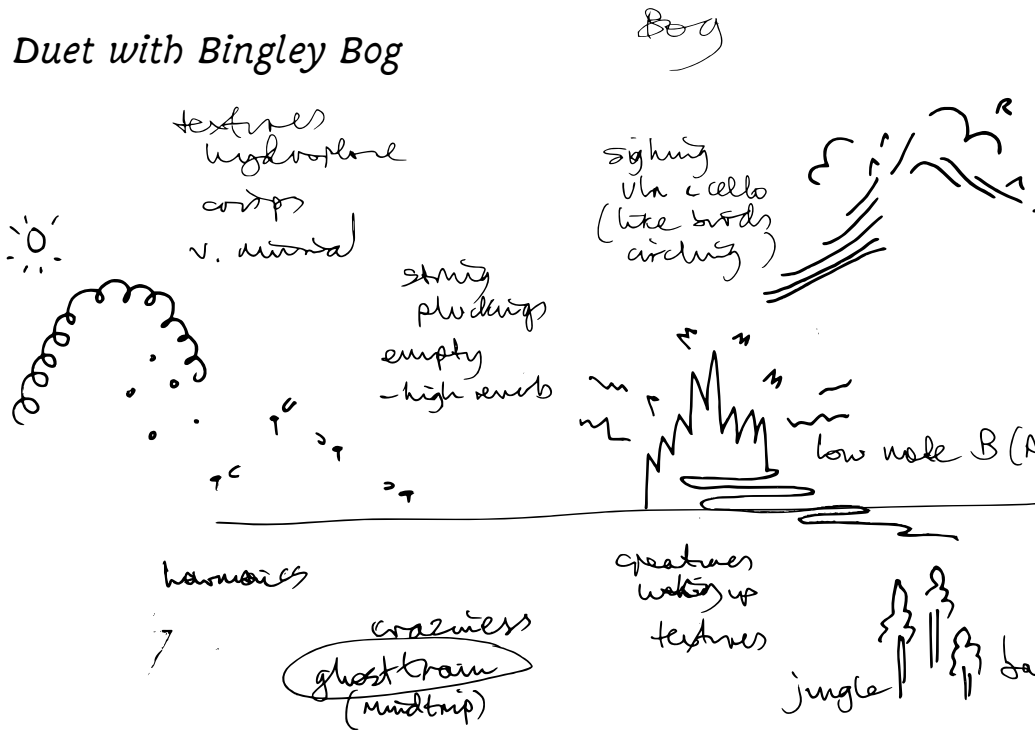
Bog Snail

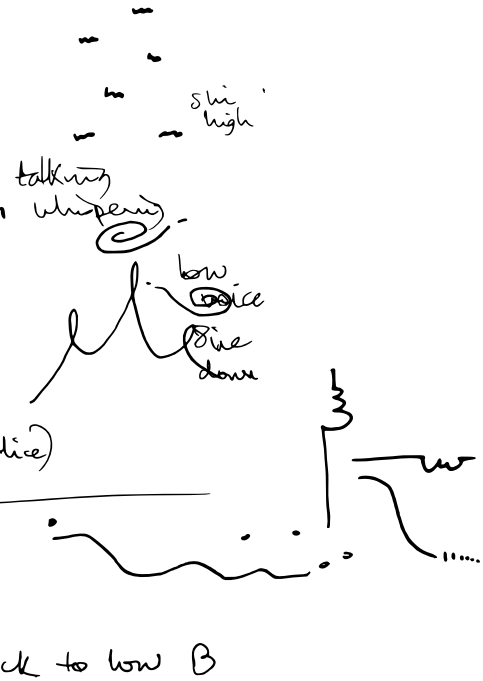






A Duet with Bingley Bog





Graphic Score

Score

This is a graphic score for our improvised set at dusk in the bog.

It is not your classical definiton of a musical score as there are not notes or staves but drawings combined with sparse instructions for the performer.

If you look at the beginning of the piece, it says, "textures, hydrophone, very minimal". This is then up to the performer to interpret how to play such things in their own way.

I love using my Behringer Edge synthesizer to craft plonky sounds. This is my interpretation of textures.

How would **you** play it?

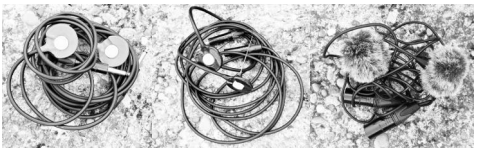






Instruments

These are some of the specialised microphones and sound devices that I used to record the wildlife and *anthropogenic activities at the bog.



(L-R) Contact, Ecoutic, Omnidirectional Condenser

Each of these microphones listen to different signals in their own special way. A contact mic captures vibrations but not sound as we know it. An ecoutic mic allows you to attach a probe to it so you can listen to vibrations in the ground!

*Changes in nature made by people.

Field recording



(Left)
A pair of Hydrophone microphones entangled

The hydrophone is one of my favourite mics because it allows me to capture sounds from any body of water. If you are reading this during our improvised performance at the bog, can you hear the splooshes?



(L-R) Recording devices from Tascam and Sony

Wildflowers

Bingley North Bog is aflush with wildflowers. They say you can't bring a botanist anywhere because they'd get stuck in a carpark - well, this was definitely the case here! Watch where you're trampling, it's an entire ecosystem under yer foot :)



Water mint

Also known as **HORSE MINT, BISHOPWORT, LILAC-FLOWER;** this herb is non-toxic to pets. Mint tea made with this plant is recommended for colds and flu. They taste milder and earthier than your usual mint plant. The leaves have a soft, furry texture.

The water mint leverages its potent fragrance to attract pollinators such as bees and repel herbivorous pests. It is also resillient to flooding and produces dense clusters of attractive lilac flowers.

Not a weed

Lifespan - **Perennial**

Native species to the UK

a delicious damp fragrance in wet meadows



Water mint
Mentha aquatica

Curly dock

Also known as CURLED DOCK, YELLOW DOCK; this plant is **toxic** to pets but their tender leaves and seeds can be eaten in salads or cooked (tho mildly toxic to humans if eaten in large doses). Historically a natural remedy for skin and digestive issues, their strong stalks can be spun into fabric and the roots yield a yellowish-brown dye.

The curly dock restores ecosystems lost to fire or human activity, and absorbs heavy metals like lead!

Considered a **weed**

wot a great weed!

Lifespan - **Perennial**

Native species to the UK



Curly dock
Rumex cripus

Meadowsweet

Also known as BITTERSWEET, QUEEN OF THE MEADOW, KISS-ME-QUICK; this herb produces creamy, lofty blossoms that attract a wide variety of insect pollinators.

In folklore, it's believed to possess qualities of harmony, peace and love so was regularly used in bridal bouquets. Also believed to dispel negative emotions so were strewn across floors during medieval times.

A leaf of of it gave a fine relish to a cup of claret.

Not a weed

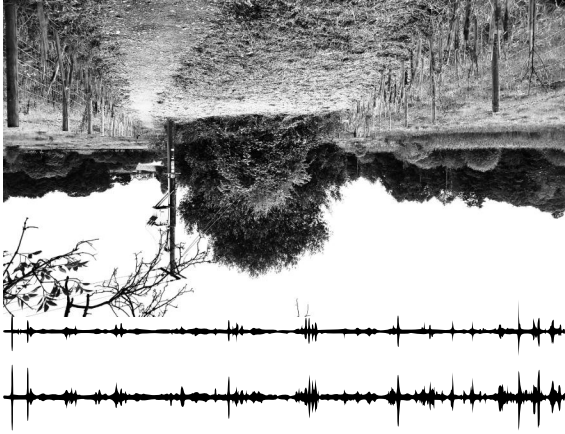
Lifespan - **Perennial**

Native species to the UK



Meadowsweet

Filipendula ulmaria



field recording of
t' bog at sunset



This zine was created by **shi Blank**, artist in residence at Bingley North Bog for three months in 2026.

shi was one of ten artists commissioned by Bradford Culture Company to explore specific sites on the Bradford Pennine Gateway National Nature Reserve.

If you want to hear the field recordings, read more about the residency, or download this zine, hop on over to

https://notshi.github.io/bog

Bradford Pennine Gateway
National Nature Reserve

BRADFORD
Culture Company

Made possible with
Heritage
Fund

Bogs *of* Bratfud

by shi Blank

zine version 2.3
(not printed on loo roll lol)

All photos taken by **shi**
25th August 2026 at Bingley Bo(n)g

Except the one of me
taken by Alice Gilmour <3

Typefaces used

BBB ReadMe (2025)
by Eugénie Bidaut, Ludi Loiseau
& Clara Sambot

BBB DM Sans (2023)
by Camille Circlude, Eugénie Bidaut,
Mariel Nils & Bérénice Bouin